

Microsoft Windows Activation Instructions

KMS Activation Guide for Windows 10 and Windows 11
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This document describes the Microsoft Windows activation procedure using **Microsoft Key Management Service (KMS)**. Individual MAK keys are not required. As per KMS licensing policy, a minimum number of clients must be registered before activation.

Important Note: Activation is based on the KMS server. The Windows client must be connected to the institute network and the system date, time, and time zone must be correct.

Before You Begin

- Log into the machine using an account with administrative privileges.
- Ensure that the time zone is set to **(UTC+05:30) Chennai, Kolkata, Mumbai, New Delhi**.
- Ensure that the system date and time of the KMS client are synchronized with the KMS host.
- Keep the machine connected to the institute network during activation.

Activation Procedure

Step 1: Open Command Prompt as Administrator.

Press the **Start** icon, type **CMD**, right-click on **Command Prompt**, and choose **Run as administrator**. Ensure that the title bar shows **Administrator**.

```
Administrator: C:\Windows\System32\cmd.exe
```

Step 2: Verify the current directory.

At the Command Prompt window, verify that the current directory is **C:\Windows\System32**. If it is not, run the command below.

```
CD C:\Windows\System32
```

Step 3: Set the KMS server.

Run the command below to point the Windows client to the institute KMS server.

```
cscript slmgr.vbs /skms kms.iitkgp.ac.in:1688
```

Step 4: Activate Windows.

Run the activation command below and wait for the activation confirmation.

```
cscript slmgr.vbs /ato
```

Step 5: Close Command Prompt.

After successful activation, close the Command Prompt window.

Command Summary

```
CD C:\Windows\System32  
  
cscript slmgr.vbs /skms kms.iitkgp.ac.in:1688  
  
cscript slmgr.vbs /ato
```

Completion

Once the activation command completes successfully, Windows should be activated through the institute KMS server.

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